

Pre-Lecture Analysis Sheet

Week 3 · Pulse Diagnosis 脈診 — 28 Qualities, Normal Pulse, Positions
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How to use this sheet:

Before lecture → complete Sections A–D and the pre-lecture case questions. Rate your confidence honestly.

During lecture → annotate directly — add answers, corrections, and new insights in the lined spaces.

After lecture → complete Section F, update confidence ratings, and finish the clinical case.

Name:

Date:

EAM310

Week 3

Summer 2026

A · Learning Targets — I Can Statements

Rate your confidence before lecture (Pre) and after lecture (Post) by circling a number 1-5 in each column. 1 = can't do it yet · 5 = fully confident

I Can Statement	Pre-Lecture Confidence	Post-Lecture Confidence
Name the three qualities of a normal pulse (Stomach-Qi, Spirit, Root) and explain what each reflects physiologically.	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5
Locate all six cun-guan-chi positions (left and right) and state the organ assigned to each.	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5
Classify all 28 pulse qualities into their six groupings (Depth, Rate, Strength, Size, Length, Shape/Rhythm).	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5
Discriminate between Knotted, Hasty, and Intermittent pulses by rate and regularity of interruptions.	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5
State the normal seasonal pulse for all four seasons, including approximate date ranges (Wiry/Flooding/Hair-like/Stone-like).	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5
Given a clinical presentation, predict the expected pulse quality and confirm at the correct organ position.	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5

B · Activate — Connect to What You Know

B1 · From Week 2 to Today

Week 2 covered the Eight Principles (Bā Gāng) — Exterior/Interior, Cold/Heat, Deficiency/Excess, Yin/Yang — and introduced tongue and pulse positions. Today Week 3 goes deep on pulse: you will learn to feel the 28 qualities, understand how each maps to a pattern, and start integrating pulse position with quality for full diagnosis.

What do you already know about pulse diagnosis? Write whatever comes to mind — positions, qualities, anything:

B2 · Connect the Dots

How might each of these concepts from prior weeks connect to today's pulse content?

Eight Principles Exterior pattern → what pulse quality would you expect at the surface level?

Cold pattern vs Heat pattern → which produces a Slow pulse and which produces a Rapid pulse? Why?

Qi Deficiency (from Week 1) → which pulse quality would you most expect? Why?

Phlegm or Dampness accumulation → what pulse quality is the classic sign? (Hint: Week 2 quick ref)

Fill in your definition/mnemonic before lecture. Refine it during and after class. Blank = opportunity to learn it live.

Character	Pinyin	English	My Definition / Feel / Clinical Note
脈診	Mài Zhěn	Pulse Diagnosis	
浮脈	Fú Mài	Floating Pulse	
沉脈	Chén Mài	Deep Pulse	
遲脈	Chí Mài	Slow Pulse	
數脈	Shuò Mài	Rapid Pulse	
滑脈	Huá Mài	Slippery Pulse	
澀脈	Sè Mài	Choppy Pulse	
弦脈	Xián Mài	Wiry Pulse	
緊脈	Jǐn Mài	Tight Pulse	
芤脈	Kōu Mài	Hollow Pulse	
結脈	Jié Mài	Knotted Pulse	
促脈	Cù Mài	Hasty Pulse	
代脈	Dài Mài	Intermittent Pulse	
胃氣	Wèi Qì	Stomach-Qi (in pulse)	
寸關尺	Cùn Guān Chǐ	Three Pulse Positions	

D · Anticipatory Questions — Answer During Lecture

These questions preview exactly what the lecture will teach. **Leave blank before lecture** — fill in the answers as the material is covered. Come back and expand after class.

Normal Pulse & Positions 正常脈 / 脈位

Q1 · THE THREE QUALITIES OF A NORMAL PULSE ★

What are the three essential qualities every normal pulse must have, and what does each one reflect about the patient's fundamental health?

Hint: Three qualities — not four. Which reflects the Heart? Which reflects Kidney? Slide 172.

Q2 · THE SIX POSITIONS ★

Complete the pulse position table from memory first, then verify from the lecture:

Position	Left Hand — Organ(s)	Right Hand — Organ(s)
寸 Cun (1st / Index)		
關 Guan (2nd / Middle)		
尺 Chi (3rd / Ring)		

Depth, Rate & Strength Qualities 深淺 / 速率 / 強弱

Q3 · DEPTH GROUP — FLOATING VS. DEEP ★

A Floating pulse and a Deep pulse are at opposite ends of the depth spectrum. What does each indicate — and what changes the meaning when you combine them with Weak or Full?

Hint: Floating = exterior (but also...?). Deep + Weak vs. Deep + Full give different diagnoses. Slides 177–181.

Q4 · RATE — RAPID & SLOW COMBINATIONS ★

Rapid pulse indicates Heat — but a Rapid + Empty pulse and a Rapid + Full pulse indicate very different conditions. Explain both, and state what a Slow + Weak pulse indicates vs. Slow + Full.

Hint: Think Empty-Heat vs Full-Heat; Empty-Cold vs Full-Cold. Slides 182–185.

Q5 · SHAPE — WIRY VS. TIGHT ★

Both Wiry and Tight feel taut. What is the textural difference between them, and what does each primarily indicate? When would a Wiry pulse be completely normal?

Hint: Wiry = bowstring. Tight = twisted rope. One has a seasonal context. Slides 203–206.

Rhythm Irregulars & Clinical Significance 節律

Q6 · KNOTTED / HASTY / INTERMITTENT — THE THREE IRREGULAR PULSES ★

Fill in the table during lecture:

Pulse	Rate	Stops are...	Primary Indication	Severity
Knotted 結				
Hasty 促				
Intermittent 代				

Q7 · HOLLOW PULSE — WHAT MAKES IT DIAGNOSTIC ★

The Hollow pulse is classically described as "like pressing a scallion stalk." Describe the three-level finding that produces this sensation, and what clinical emergency it signals.

Hint: Present at surface AND deep, but empty in the middle. Slide 209.

Seasonal Pulses & Classical Context 季節脈

Q8 · SEASONAL PULSES — ALL FOUR ★★ (SCHRIER: "GOOD QUIZ QUESTION")

Fill in each season's expected normal pulse AND date range during lecture:

Season	Date Range	Normal Pulse Quality	Physiological Rationale
Spring 春			
Summer 夏			
Autumn 秋			
Winter 冬			

Q9 · SIX CLIMATIC QI → PULSE SIGNATURES

From the Seasonal Pulses slide deck — which pulse does each of the Six Climatic Qi (六淫) produce? Fill in during class:

Pathogen (六淫)	Expected Pulse
Wind 風	
Cold 寒	
Summer-Heat 暑	
Dampness 濕	
Dryness 燥	
Fire/Heat 火	

Q10 · POSITION + QUALITY = DIAGNOSIS

A Wiry pulse felt only at the Left Guan position means something very different from a Wiry pulse everywhere. Explain why position matters as much as quality — what would Left Guan Wiry specifically suggest?

Hint: Left Guan = Liver/Gallbladder. Wiry = Liver disharmony. Position localizes the pattern.

E · Clinical Case — Apply It Before & After

Case Vignette: Ms. Lin, 34-year-old female dancer

Ms. Lin is a 34-year-old competitive Latin dancer presenting to your clinic with **chronic fatigue and lower back soreness** for the past 3 months. She trains 6 days a week, 4–5 hours per session. She reports **dizziness when she stands up quickly**, occasional **blurred vision, dry eyes**, and **night sweats**. She is rarely thirsty but when she drinks, she prefers room temperature water. Her menstrual cycle has become irregular — **periods are late and scanty**. On examination: tongue is **pale and slightly dry with a thin coat**. You palpate her radial pulse.

Chronic fatigue

Lower back soreness

Dizziness on standing

Night sweats

Blurred vision / dry eyes

Scanty periods

Tongue: pale, slightly dry

Prefers room temp water

Pre-Lecture Questions — Answer Based on Your Current Knowledge

Before the lecture, do your best with these. Guessing is fine — it primes your brain to receive the lecture material.

PRE · Q1

Based on Ms. Lin's presentation, what pulse quality or qualities would you most expect to feel — and at which position(s)? Explain your reasoning.

PRE · Q2

Using the Eight Principles from Week 2: Is this primarily an Interior or Exterior condition? Deficiency or Excess? What evidence supports your answer?

PRE · Q3

The night sweats and blurred vision in a young female dancer raise a specific TCM concern. Name the pattern you suspect and the Vital Substance most likely depleted.

Post-Lecture Questions — Complete After Class

POST · Q1

State the specific pulse quality you would expect at each of Ms. Lin's six positions. Explain what pattern each finding points to. (Use cun/guan/chi × left/right format.)

POST · Q2

Which of the 28 pulse qualities did today's lecture make most relevant to Ms. Lin's case? Name the quality, its feel, and what it confirms about her pattern.

POST · Q3

Ms. Lin's night sweats occur around 1–3 AM. How does this timing (Liver/Gallbladder time on the organ clock) interact with her pulse findings? What treatment principle would the pulse support?

Complete this section within 24 hours of lecture for maximum retention.

I Can Now Confidently...

Still Unclear — I Need to Review...

Connected to Other Learning...

Concept Map Completion — 28 Pulse Qualities by Classification

Complete the classification map using only what you can recall. Fill in the blank columns:

脈診 Pulse Diagnosis — Classify the 28 Qualities		
Classification Group	Pulse Qualities in This Group	Core Theme / What It Measures
Depth		
Rate		
Strength		
Size		
Length		
Shape		
Rhythm		

Homework Tracker

Assigned Homework (from lecture):

☐ Task 1:

Practice pulse-taking on at least **3 people** before next class. For each: record depth, rate, strength, quality, and any position-specific findings using the 6-position grid format. Write up in your Pulse/Tongue Journal.

☐ Task 2:

Complete Pulse/Tongue Journal entries for this week. Tongue map + full 6-position pulse grid on every page. Entries 1–25 due at Midterm (Aug 7).

☐ Task 3:

Quiz 3 prep — reproduce all 28 pulse qualities from memory by name, feel, and indication. Practice the seasonal pulse mnemonic until automatic.

Notes on practice / logistics:

